

Indonesia

In a series of actions starting in 1950, the NYPD exerted significant influence over the training of the Indonesian police force. The United States had the explicit goal of limiting communism in Indonesia, and they did so by strengthening the Indonesian police in order to crack down on communist efforts in the nation. In 1950, former NYPD patrolman, Lt. Col. Louis E. Kubler was hired as a technical advisor to the Indonesian police. He worked alongside General Soekanto to create blacklists and expand training of the police force to increase understanding of advanced weaponry, counterinsurgency, and espionage. In 1955, the United States government increased the funds for the Indonesian police by 6 million dollars. This further bolstered the police's power in Indonesia and provided a way for the United States to maintain their influence on the region.

Ten years later, in 1965 the United States used their influence over the military to back a coup d-etat. General Suharto who had worked directly with Lt. Col. Louis E. Kubler took over the Indonesian government from President Sukarno. Once in power, General Suharto formed army and police death squads to target members of the PKI (Communist Party of Indonesia). They also targeted people on blacklists created by C.I.A and NYPD police intelligence.

Interactions between the NYPD and the political climate in Indonesia also occurred in the United States. On October 21, 1966, the NYPD's Bureau of Special Services and Investigations carried out surveillance on the Youth Against War and Fascism protest in New York City. This protest was speaking out against the civilian massacres that were occurring in Indonesia.

Citations:

Kuzmarov, J. (2012) "“Free Government Cannot Exist Without Safeguards Against Subversion”: The Clandestine Cold War in Southeast Asia’ in *Modernizing Repression*. Amherst: University of Massachusetts Press, pp 101-106.

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